inevitably brought protest from the Soviet government.[171] Again, Afghanistan tried to protect itself by garnering British support. In an interview with Humphrys in April 1922, Tarzi asked if it were not possible to use Enver Pasha as an instrument to promote the joint interests of Afghanistan and Britain and create a stable Bokhara. The Afghan Foreign Minister believed that Enver Pasha could remove the Bolsheviks from Bokhara if he was supplied with some 60,000 rifles.[172] In the opinion of both Humphrys and Reading, however, Britain should steer clear of the Bokhara situation. As the viceroy pointed out, Enver Pasha in particular was an ambitious adventurer, and was not to be trusted.[173]

In an effort to try to win over Britain to his plans, Amanullah had even begun to try to appease the Indian government by cracking down on anti-British intrigue within his country. In February 1922, for example, the emir summoned many of the Indian revolutionaries who were resident in Kabul and warned them to refrain from anti-British activity or risk being expelled from Afghanistan.[174] Economic and political considerations also required the emir to ease back on his more militant attitude towards India, as he simply could not afford to completely alienate Delhi.[175] Perhaps unsurprisingly, this period of courtship with Britain coincided with a period of decline in Afghan relations with Soviet Russia. As one British source noted in February 1922, 'There appears no doubt that the Russians [in Kabul] are now subjected to all the petty restrictions and annoyances with which the British Mission was formerly favoured.'[176] Before he was recalled by his government following Curzon's note, the Bolshevik representative in Kabul, Raskolnikov, was busy making himself unpopular - information reached the Foreign Office of a 'strong resentment felt by the Afghan Government at the disloyal activity of Monsieur Raskolnikoff, who is alleged to be intriguing with seditious persons with the object of encouraging disaffection within the country'.[177] Thus, just as in Persia, Bolshevik influence appeared on the wane.

Afghanistan was a fickle friend, however, and such goodwill towards Britain was not to be forever assured. By 1923, following a series of irritations and petty annoyances caused by Afghan behaviour, relations between the two countries would decline to the point where London was threatening to recall its Legation from Kabul.[178] Matters were not helped by